

Jonathan Strickland

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Rust · Python · Terraform · AWS · Observability · Platform Engineering · CI/CD

Work Experience

Filament

Search · Authorization · Observability · RAG · MCP · RabbitMQ · Kafka · ECS · Matrix

Software Engineer (April 2025 - Now)

- Developed a full-stack search system for Filament's member directory, designing OpenSearch schemas through four iterations with autocomplete, fuzzy matching, semantic vector search, and zero-downtime reindexing, and decommissioning the legacy search endpoint
- Led implementation of Activity Center real-time notifications, authoring the RabbitMQ architecture RFC, building a Twisted async connection pool with reconnection and health monitoring, and delivering event-driven reaction tracking and read/unread state
- Built and expanded internal CLI tooling for local development, ECS deployments, secrets management, Terraform operations, Datadog monitoring, and production debugging, establishing it as a central interface for daily engineering workflows
- Developed MCP plugin for Matrix homeserver enabling AI agents to interact with the messaging platform, implementing OAuth 2.1 + PKCE, Postgres-backed session state, and an auditable authorization policy for tools (channel operations, messaging, reactions, profile management)
- Established observability practices across Python and Rust services, integrating Datadog APM and OpenTelemetry, creating the shared `filament-otel` Rust library, and instrumenting push notification delivery paths to diagnose production issues
- Created event-driven CLI audit/deployment pipeline using EventBridge, Lambda, Kafka, and Rust consumers to provide deployment visibility, Matrix notifications, and automated ECS/Terraform comments on pull requests

Mercury

Authorization · Postgres · Refactoring

Senior Software Engineer, User Management (May 2024 - December 2024)

- Planned and implemented customizable roles for user management, enabling customers to define roles with fine-grained permissions and account access while coordinating risk evaluation, rollout sequencing, and mitigation work
- Helped to centralize authorization logic spread throughout the codebase into one backend policy, while adapting frontend component authorization logic to defer to the backend as a source of truth

Oso HQ

Authorization · Testing · Customer Interviews · Product Research · Compilers

Software Engineer (November 2022 - November 2023)

- Implemented Policy Testing for Oso Cloud, extending the Polar language syntax to support executable authorization test cases with cloud execution and reporting
- Prototyped and shipped Oso Modeler, a visual tool for constructing executable authorization policies from authorization requirements
- Extended Polar lexer to preserve comments and prototyped an automatic formatter for policy code

Metafy

Ruby · Search · Algolia

Senior Software Engineer (June 2022 - September 2022)

- Built backend features in Ruby using Hanami, Algolia, and GraphQL, including enhancements to search indexes for real-time filtering of coaches by character, position, and popularity

Recurse Center

Rust · Haskell · PowerPC · React · CTFs · Pair Programming

Participant (March 2022 - June 2022)

- Attended 12-week self-directed programming retreat, building `melee-inject`: a Rust reverse-engineering project for modifying Super Smash Bros. Melee GameCube images

American Eagle Outfitters

Kubernetes · DevOps · Ansible · Bamboo · Bitbucket · Cloudfoundry · GCP · AWS

Systems Engineer (December 2016 - January 2022)

- Developed and maintained continuous integration pipelines for applications and provisioned infrastructure, empowering teams to create pull requests to apply changes, using Python, Bash, Rust, Haskell
- Used Terraform to provision cloud environments, developing modules for different components of American Eagle infrastructure on AWS, GCP, GKE
- First responder for on-call rotation, addressing production AE.com issues, failures in build + deployment automation
- Used Terraform + Bamboo to create self-service "ephemeral environments" - when any UI developer opens a pull request, a new environment is launched, the new code is deployed, a DNS record is set up, the developer is sent a link to the live environment on their pull request to validate

Industry Weapon

Python · Web · Angular · Flask

Contractor (December 2015 - June 2016)

- Developed and shipped custom software integrations for internal digital signage platform, implementing version control for all teams

Cytobank

Ruby · Puppet

System Administrator (January 2014 - August 2015)

- Used Puppet and Ruby to automate configuration, participated in regular on-call rotations, facilitated migration from OpenVZ physical hosts to AWS

